POVERTY, HUNGER, FOOD AND NUTRITION SECURITY

VICIOUS CYCLE → SECURITY TYPES → INDICATOR CARD → STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT CARD → PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD → LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

VICIOUS CYCLE

VICIOUS CYCLE · INCOME AND ASSET DEPRIVATION RESTRICTS THE HOUSEHOLD FOOD BASKET · FOOD INSECURITY · CALORIE DEFICIT PLUS PROTEIN AND MICRONUTRIENT DEFICIT · IMPAIRED DEVELOPMENT · COGNITIVE, PHYSICAL AND IMMUNE CAPACITY FALL · LOW HUMAN CAPITAL · SCHOOLING ATTAINMENT AND PRODUCTIVITY FALL

POVERTY → income and asset deprivation restricts the household food basket → FOOD INSECURITY: calorie deficit plus protein and micronutrient deficit → IMPAIRED DEVELOPMENT: cognitive, physical and immune capacity fall → LOW HUMAN CAPITAL: schooling attainment and productivity fall → LOW EARNINGS: the deprivation is transmitted to the next generation

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- POVERTY → income and asset deprivation restricts the household food basket
- FOOD INSECURITY: calorie deficit plus protein and micronutrient deficit

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- IMPAIRED DEVELOPMENT: cognitive, physical and immune capacity fall
- LOW HUMAN CAPITAL: schooling attainment and productivity fall

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LOW EARNINGS: the deprivation is transmitted to the next generation
- POVERTY → income and asset deprivation restricts the household food basket

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LOW EARNINGS: the deprivation is transmitted to the next generation.

01

STAGE 01

SECURITY TYPES

SECURITY TYPES · FOOD SECURITY · RELIABLE ACCESS TO SUFFICIENT, SAFE AND NUTRITIOUS FOOD · CARRIED BY · STATUTORY FOODGRAIN ENTITLEMENT; A CALORIE AND GRAIN-ACCESS INSTRUMENT · NUTRITION SECURITY · DIETARY DIVERSITY, MICRONUTRIENTS, CARE PRACTICES, SANITATION · THE DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM CAN WORK WHILE NUTRITION OUTCOMES STAGNATE

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
FOOD SECURITY → reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food	NUTRITION SECURITY → dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices, sanitation	FOOD SECURITY → reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food
CARRIED BY → statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument	CONSEQUENCE → the distribution system can work while nutrition outcomes stagnate	CARRIED BY → statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- FOOD SECURITY → reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food
- CARRIED BY → statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- NUTRITION SECURITY → dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices, sanitation
- CONSEQUENCE → the distribution system can work while nutrition outcomes stagnate

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- FOOD SECURITY → reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food
- CARRIED BY → statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → the distribution system can work while nutrition outcomes stagnate.

02

STAGE 02

INDICATOR CARD

INDICATOR CARD · LOW HEIGHT-FOR-AGE UNDER FIVE; CHRONIC CUMULATIVE DEPRIVATION · LOW WEIGHT-FOR-HEIGHT UNDER FIVE; RECENT OR ACUTE SHORTAGE OR · HAEMOGLOBIN DEFICIENCY FROM IRON, FOLATE OR VITAMIN B12 SHORTFALL · WEIGHT-FOR-HEIGHT BELOW MINUS THREE STANDARD DEVIATIONS; THERAPEUTIC CARE · MINUS TWO TO MINUS THREE STANDARD DEVIATIONS; COMMUNITY SUPPLEMENTARY

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation	ANAEMIA → haemoglobin deficiency from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall	MAM → minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding
WASTING → low weight-for-height under five; recent or acute shortage or illness	SAM → weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations; therapeutic care	STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation
- WASTING → low weight-for-height under five; recent or acute shortage or illness

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ANAEMIA → haemoglobin deficiency from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall
- SAM → weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations; therapeutic care

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- MAM → minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding
- STUNTING → low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAM → minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding.

03

STAGE 03

STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT CARD

STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT CARD · 5 JULY 2013; A SHIFT FROM A WELFARE TO · 5 KG PER PERSON PER MONTH PRIORITY; 35 KG · COVERAGE RULE · UP TO 75 PER CENT RURAL AND 50 PER · OFFICIAL COUNT · MAXIMUM COVERAGE 81.34 CRORE PERSONS; ABOUT 80 CRORE COVERED · HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD

ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach → QUANTUM → 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month → COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population → OFFICIAL COUNT → maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present → HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD → eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE / DATE

- ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach
- QUANTUM → 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month Antyodaya

WHAT IT PROVES

- COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population
- OFFICIAL COUNT → maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present

CLAIM LIMIT

- HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD → eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration card
- ENACTED → 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COVERAGE RULE → up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population.

04

STAGE 04

PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD

PRICE DISCIPLINE CARD · STATUTORY CEILING · RICE 3 RUPEES, WHEAT 2 RUPEES, COARSE GRAINS 1 · CURRENT POLICY · FREE OF COST TO ANTYODAYA AND PRIORITY HOUSEHOLDS SINCE · THE WELFARE GRAIN SCHEME WAS MERGED INTO THE ACT · THE UNION CABINET EXTENDED FREE DISTRIBUTION FOR FIVE YEARS · NEVER STATE THE CEILING AS THE PRICE A BENEFICIARY

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram	AUTHORITY → the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date	RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays
CURRENT POLICY → free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023	EXTENSION → the Union Cabinet extended free distribution for five years to December 2028	STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram
- CURRENT POLICY → free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- AUTHORITY → the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date
- EXTENSION → the Union Cabinet extended free distribution for five years to December 2028

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays
- STATUTORY CEILING → rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays.

05

STAGE 05

LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS

LIFE-CYCLE PROVISIONS · PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN · NUTRITIOUS MEAL FREE OF COST; MATERNITY BENEFIT · MATERNITY BENEFIT · NOT LESS THAN 6000 RUPEES TO PARTLY COMPENSATE WAGE · CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS · MEAL THROUGH ANGANWADI CENTRES AND THROUGH SCHOOLS · MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit

MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss → CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS → meal through anganwadi centres and through schools → MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit
- MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS → meal through anganwadi centres and through schools
- MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN → nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit
- MATERNITY BENEFIT → not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX → higher nutritional norms are prescribed.

06

STAGE 06

REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY

REMEDY AND RESPONSIBILITY · THE ENTITLED PERSON MAY CLAIM A FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE · GOVERNED BY · THE FOOD SECURITY ALLOWANCE RULES, 2015 · ALLOCATION, TRANSPORT TO DEPOTS AND ASSISTANCE TO THE FAIR-PRICE · IDENTIFICATION, RATION CARDS AND DISTRIBUTION OF THE ENTITLEMENT · ATTRIBUTE A DELIVERY FAILURE TO A NAMED TIER, NEVER

NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

GOVERNED BY → the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015 → CENTRE → allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep → STATES → identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State
- GOVERNED BY → the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- CENTRE → allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep
- STATES → identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- USE → attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general
- NON-SUPPLY → the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: USE → attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general.

07

STAGE 07

SERVICE LAYERS BY AGE

SERVICE LAYERS BY AGE · POSHAN 2.0 · MINISTRY OF WOMEN AND CHILD DEVELOPMENT; ANGANWADI CENTRES · ITS SERVICES · SUPPLEMENTARY NUTRITION, GROWTH MONITORING, PRE-SCHOOL, REFERRAL · PM POSHAN · MINISTRY OF EDUCATION; COOKED MEAL IN CLASSES I TO · ITS OBJECTIVES

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres	PM POSHAN → Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII	TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions
ITS SERVICES → supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral	ITS OBJECTIVES → attendance, retention and improved nutritional status	POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres
- ITS SERVICES → supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- PM POSHAN → Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII
- ITS OBJECTIVES → attendance, retention and improved nutritional status

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions
- POSHAN 2.0 → Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions.

08

STAGE 08

RATION FORMAT TRADE-OFF

RATION FORMAT TRADE-OFF · TAKE-HOME RATION · DRY RATION COOKED AT HOME; PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN · ALSO FOR · CHILDREN BETWEEN SIX MONTHS AND THREE YEARS · HOT COOKED MEAL · SERVED AT THE ANGANWADI CENTRE OR THE SCHOOL · THE HOT MEAL GUARANTEES CONSUMPTION AT THE POINT OF

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women	HOT COOKED MEAL → served at the anganwadi centre or the school	COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed
ALSO FOR → children between six months and three years	GAIN → the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery	TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women
- ALSO FOR → children between six months and three years

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- HOT COOKED MEAL → served at the anganwadi centre or the school
- GAIN → the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed
- TAKE-HOME RATION → dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST → it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed.

09

STAGE 09

PORTABILITY MECHANISM

PORTABILITY MECHANISM · A MIGRANT IS LISTED ON A STATE-SPECIFIC ROLL AND · AADHAAR-SEEDED RATION CARD READ AT AN ELECTRONIC POINT-OF-SALE MACHINE · THE EXISTING ENTITLEMENT IS DRAWN AT ANY ENABLED FAIR-PRICE · IT IS NOT A SEPARATE CARD AND NOT A · CLAIM LIMIT · THE CUMULATIVE TRANSACTION COUNT RISES CONTINUOUSLY AND IS NOT

PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving → MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine → EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop → LIMIT → it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement → CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving
- MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop
- LIMIT → it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here
- PROBLEM → a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLAIM LIMIT → the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here.

10

STAGE 10

CONVERGENCE BANK

CONVERGENCE BANK · FEEDING, MICRONUTRIENTS, GROWTH MONITORING, BREASTFEEDING SUPPORT · WATER AND SANITATION, AGRICULTURE, SOCIAL PROTECTION, GIRLS SCHOOLING · THE NATIONAL ANAEMIA STRATEGY USES A SIX-BY-SIX-BY-SIX INTERVENTION DESIGN · REACHES SELECTED MICRONUTRIENT GAPS AT SCALE · IT CANNOT REPLACE DIETARY DIVERSITY, INFECTION CONTROL, SAFE WATER

NUTRITION-SPECIFIC → feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support → NUTRITION-SENSITIVE → water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling → ANAEMIA → the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design → FORTIFICATION → reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale → LIMIT → it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- NUTRITION-SPECIFIC → feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support
- NUTRITION-SENSITIVE → water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- ANAEMIA → the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design
- FORTIFICATION → reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LIMIT → it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment
- NUTRITION-SPECIFIC → feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment.

11

STAGE 11

DATED OUTCOME AND ANSWER SPINE

DATED OUTCOME AND ANSWER SPINE · ROUND FIVE 2019-21 · STUNTING 35.5, WASTING 19.3, CHILD ANAEMIA 67.1 PER CENT · ROUND SIX 2023-24 · UNDER-FIVE STUNTING 29.3 PER CENT; RELEASED 29 MAY 2026 · ROUND SIX COVERED 715 DISTRICTS AND ABOUT 6.79 LAKH · NAME THE ROUND BESIDE EVERY VALUE AND NEVER MERGE · AVAILABILITY, ACCESS, ABSORPTION AND UTILISATION, THEN A GRADED VERDICT

ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent → ROUND SIX 2023-24 → under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026 → SCOPE → round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households → RULE → name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds → CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent
- ROUND SIX 2023-24 → under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- SCOPE → round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households
- RULE → name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict
- ROUND FIVE 2019-21 → stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · HIGHEST RETURN ON INTERVENTION · POSHAN 2.0 (FIRST-1000-DAYS FOCUS), PM POSHAN (SCHOOL · WASH CONVERGENCE (SBM, JJM), INCOME SUPPORT (DBT · ONORC FOR MIGRANT-WORKER INCLUSION. · NFSA, 2013 · STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT; STATE-WISE IDENTIFICATION OF PRIORITY · POSHAN 2.0

OPTIONAL RIGHTS AND CAPABILITY DEPTH

- highest return on intervention
- Nutrition-specific: Poshan 2.0 (first-1000-days focus), PM POSHAN (school
- Nutrition-sensitive: WASH convergence (SBM, JJM), income support (DBT,
- Portability: ONORC for migrant-worker inclusion.

INDICATOR, ROUND AND STATUS LIMIT

- NFSA, 2013: Statutory entitlement; state-wise identification of priority
- Poshan 2.0 / Saksham Anganwadi (MWCD): Consolidates ICDS, Poshan Abhiyaan
- PM POSHAN (MoE): Centrally-sponsored scheme with cost-sharing between
- ONORC: Requires Aadhaar seeding of ration cards, ePoS deployment at

COMPARATIVE WELFARE-DESIGN NUANCE

- CAUTION: Poshan Tracker (app): Real-time data entry by anganwadi workers for
- 2024 GS-II PYQ Q7: The question directly tests the vicious-cycle concept
- CAUTION: ONORC during COVID-19 lockdowns: Enabled migrant workers stranded outside
- CAUTION: NFHS-5 inter-state variation: States like Kerala and Tamil Nadu have low

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels